REPUBLIC OF CAMEROON
Paix-Travail-Patrie
****
MINISTRY OF EMPLOYMENT AND VOCATIONAL TRAINING
****

REPUBLIC OF CAMEROON
Paix – Travail – Patrie
****
MINISTERE DE L'EMPLOI ET DE LA ET DE LA FORMATION PROFESSIONNELLE
****

NATIONAL EXAMINATION FOR THE VOCATIONAL QUALIFICATION DIPLOMA

EXAMEN NATIONAL DU DIPLOME DE QUALIFICATION PROFESSIONNELLE

Session	2026
Speciality:	Executive Secretaryship

Time allowed	4 Hours
Coefficient	2
Eliminatory mark:	<8/20

COMPREHENSIVE VOCATIONAL PAPER

No documents except those handed to candidates by the examiners are allowed.
Examiners must provide each candidate with two A4 sheets.

This paper, marked out of 40, comprises 4 (four) independent and compulsory parts.

PART I: ADMINISTRATIVE COMMUNICATION AND WRITING TECHNIQUES / 10 mks
PART II: WORK ORGANISATION AND MANAGEMENT / 10 mks
PART III: OFFICE AUTOMATION AND DIGITAL TOOLS / 10 mks
PART IV: PROFESSIONAL ENVIRONMENT AND ETHICS / 10 mks

You have recently been recruited as an executive secretary at a company Alpha Services, based in Yaoundé. Your Director will be away on mission from 20 to 25 December 2026 in Douala. The Director has assigned you to audit and improve the company's digital environment, office tools, and document management.

PART I: ADMINISTRATIVE COMMUNICATION AND WRITING TECHNIQUES (10 mks)

1. Define the following terms: memorandum (internal memo); summary report; minutes. **(0.5mkx3=1.5 mks)**
2. State 2 (two) characteristics of each documents defined above. **(0.5mk×3=1.5 mks)**
3. Prepare a memorandum informing all staff of the situation, respecting the required format, style, and components. **(7 mks)**

Marking guide

- Correct format **(3 mks)**
- Style **(2 mks)**
- Required components **(2 mks)**

PART II: WORK ORGANISATION AND MANAGEMENT (10 mks)

1. **Agenda Management** **(4 mks)**

You are responsible for managing the GM's schedule. The following appointments are already scheduled: Executive meeting on Monday, 21 December from 9:00–11:00 a.m; lunch with a partner on Tuesday, 22 December from 12:30–2:00 p.m

a) You are asked to schedule the following: **(2 mks)**

- Interview with Canal 2: 1 hour, preferred time slot, morning
- Videoconference with the Paris subsidiary: consider the one-hour time difference

b) You are also asked to: **(2 mks)**
- Prepare an AGM speech: Three hours of uninterrupted work
- Propose a schedule from 21 to 23 December, justifying your choices

2. **Filing and Archiving (3 mks)**
   a) Define the terms filing and archiving **(0.25mkx2 = 0.5 mks)**
   b) List the three (3) main filing methods for documents. **(0.5mkx3 = 1.5 mk)**
   c) Give 1 (one) advantage and disadvantage of each. **(0.5xmkx2 = 1 mk)**
3. **Priority Management / 3 mks**

a) Classify the following tasks by priority using the Eisenhower Matrix **(0.5mkx4=2 mks)**
- Prepare a file for a meeting that starts in 30 minutes
- Reply to an email from a dissatisfied client received yesterday
- File last month's invoices
- Organise a seminar scheduled in 2 months

b) Justify each classification in one line. **(0.25mkx4 = 1mk)**

PART III: OFFICE AUTOMATION AND DIGITAL TOOLS (10 mks)

1. Word processing /4 mks

a) List 4 (four) key Microsoft Word features for formatting a 20-page report with an automatic table of contents. **(0.5mkx5 = 2.5 mks)**

b) Briefly explain the purpose of each feature. **(0.5mkx4 = 2 mks)**

2. Spreadsheet **(1mkx3=3 mks)**

State the Excel formula you would use to:

a) Calculate the total of the values in cells B2 to B15;

b) Display "Approved" if cell D2>100 000, otherwise "Pending"

c) Extract the month from a date located in cell A2

3. Collaboration Tools **(3 mks)**

Your company uses Office 365. State the purpose of the following 3 (three) tools for an Executive Secretary: OneDrive, Microsoft Teams, and SharePoint. **(1mkx3 = 3 mks)**

PART IV: PROFESSIONAL ENVIRONMENT AND ETHICS / 10 mks)

1. Name the device that provides backup power during a power outage. **(0.5 mk)**
2. State 4 (four) technical responsibilities of an Executive Secretary that distinguishes them from a general secretary. **(0.5mkx3 = 1.5 mk)**
3. State the measurement unit generally used for the following: RAM, processor and screen. **(1mkx3 = 3 mks)**
4. A file comprises a file name and an extension indicating the software used to create it. Identify the software associated with the following file extensions:
5. Describe the procedure for saving a file to your computer desktop. **(0.25mkx4 = 1 mk)**
6. A visitor without an appointment insists on seeing the Director, who is in a confidential meeting. Describe the 4 (four) steps you would take to handle the situation professionally. **(0.5mkx4 = 2 mks)**

7. **Confidentiality and legal obligations**

a. Define duty of professional secrecy. **(1 mk)**

b. State 2 (two) types of documents that you must never disclose without authorization. **(0.5mkx2 = 1 mk)**

c. **Case study** The Director instructs you to prepare a dismissal letter. A colleague asks why Mr. X has been summoned. How would you respond. Justify your answer. **(1 mk)**